Darryl Hutchinson

Bilingual (en, jp) learning/game designer, UX researcher and educator with 8+ years designing and facilitating learning experiences across diverse communities in Japan and the United States. MS in Games for Learning (NYU)

darrylehutchinson@msn.com
linkedin.com/darryl-hutchinson-a8041891/
+01 845 821 5513
New York

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

PRODUCT LEAD & GAME DESIGNER - *JOY EDUCATION* **Remote (VA, USA) | 2025 - Present**

- Conducting qualitative User/UX research across four stakeholder groups; students, educators, caregivers, and out-of-school time providers, producing coded interview transcripts and pattern analysis to inform product direction
- Conducting buyer focus analysis mapping stakeholder pain points and underserved needs across current edtech services, contributing to market strategy discussions with SME and engineers to define audience and scope 1st MVP
- Facilitating co-generative design sprints with student & educators, and prototyping AI literacy playbook
- Translating reading literacy fundamentals into game designs and communicating objectives to the engineering team.

EXHIBIT MANAGER - *AMERICAN MUSEUM OF THE MOVING IMAGE* **Queens, NY, USA | 2025**

- Managed day-to-day operations of an interactive VR experience serving 200+ daily visitors, coordinating across design, curation, and technical teams to resolve blockers and maintain quality
- Conducted 50+ user observation sessions, synthesizing findings into actionable recommendations that increased engagement 25% and reduced support incidents 35%
- Produced regular status updates for internal stakeholders, tracking user experiences, communicating iteration goals

PRODUCTION INTERN - *FABLEVISION STUDIOS* **Remote (Boston, MA, USA) | 2024**

- Supported production pipeline across 4 concurrent digital titles, tracking task dependencies and coordinating deliverables across 15+ team members in design, engineering, art, and QA
- Contributed to bi-weekly milestone reviews, surfacing risks and bridging gaps across creative & technical disciplines
- Assessed, documented and communicated design flaws to lead producers, designers, and engineers

INSTRUCTOR & LESSON DESIGNER (English, Math, Science) - *JPREP / J-INSTITUTE* **Tokyo, JAPAN | 2019 - 2023**

- Designed and iterated on game-based curriculum for 100+ learners per term across 10+ concurrent courses, and supported 10+ instructors tracking performance data and adapting lesson delivery each term cycle
- Facilitated cross-functional communication for students, instructors, administrators, and parents to align goals/issues

CORPORATE INSTRUCTOR - (UD Trucks, TMG, JASDF, TEPCO, etc.) via *IES* **Tokyo/Osaka, JAPAN | 2015 - 2019**

- Designed and facilitated training program curriculum for 30+ professionals per term across diverse industries, adapting content structure and delivery for various learner needs and organizational contexts
- Created multi-layered evaluation frameworks addressing learner, client, and stakeholder needs simultaneously

QUALITY ASSURANCE / LOCALIZATION COORDINATOR - *KEYWORDS INTERNATIONAL* **Tokyo, JAPAN | 2017-2018**

- QA and localization for 4+ commercial game releases per quarter, tracking 100+ issues across concurrent titles
- Authored 50+ detailed bug reports enabling engineering teams to resolve 90% of critical issues pre-certification
- Supported J>E localization ensuring tutorial, UI/UX, and gameplay clarity met quality standards across platforms

PRODUCTION ASSISTANT (Game Design, QA & Community) - *17- BIT STUDIOS* **Kyoto, JAPAN| 2016**

- Supported sprint planning, backlog management, and milestone tracking across 3 titles in concurrent Agile/Scrum development, facilitating ceremonies and surfacing blockers
- Coordinated design and QA review cycles, capturing decisions and supporting follow-through across iterations
- Synthesized community feedback into structured reports, bridging communication between dev team and players

SKILLS & TOOLS

- ***Strategy & Analysis:*** *Market/User Research, Feedback Synthesis,* Empathy Interview/Coding, Equity-Centered Design
- ***Production & Design:*** *Agile/Scrum, Sprint Planning, Milestone Tracking, Game Mechanics, Prototyping, Playtesting*
- ***Game-Based Pedagogy:*** Collaborative Problem Solving, Graceful Failure Environments, Immediate Feedback Loops, Onboarding & Scaffolding, Gamification, Game-Based Formative Assessment, Intrinsic Motivation/Progression Systems
- ***Tools:*** *Notion, Trello, Miro, GitHub, Canva, Slack, Zoom, M365/G-Suite, Unity, Figma, Emerging Gen-AI tools*
- ***Languages:*** *English (Native), Japanese (Fluent), Spanish (Emerging)*

EDUCATION

M.S. Games for Learning New York University | *Domains: Game Design, Learning/Cognitive Sciences, UX/AI research*